29th Sunday in Ordinary Time

18 October 2026

Mission Sunday

Stamped with His Image

They come to Jesus with a trap. The Pharisees, who hated the Roman tax, and the Herodians, who lived off it, suddenly the best of friends. Say pay the tax, and the crowd turns on him. Say don't, and Rome will. Either way, he loses.

Jesus asks for a coin. Notice that he does not have one; they do. They are carrying the emperor's face in their own pockets while they ask the question. Whose image is this? Caesar's. Then give Caesar what is Caesar's and give God what is God's.

The coin bears Caesar's image. What bears God's? We do. Every person in this church, every person on the street outside, was made in the image and likeness of God. Caesar can have his coin. God wants the whole of us. The tax is a small matter. The question Jesus leaves hanging is far bigger: have you given God what is stamped with his image?

The first reading says something surprising about power. God calls Cyrus, a pagan king who has never heard of him, "his anointed", and uses him to bring the exiles home. God is not confined to the people who know his name. He works through rulers, through strangers, through history itself, and his purpose is never in doubt.

Today is World Mission Sunday. We pray for, and support, the missionaries who carry the Gospel where Christ is still unknown, and we remember that Irish men and women have been doing that for centuries, supported in their work by prayer and aid. But mission is not only abroad. St Paul tells the Thessalonians that the Gospel came to them "as power

and as the Holy Spirit and as utter conviction". That is what we are meant to carry out of here into the mission territory of our own parishes and beyond.

This week, give God what is his, starting with yourself.

Fr Sean

Announcements

Last week's collections amounted to: ***Melmount:*** £2901.00; ***Sion Mills*****:** £1465.00. Thank you.

Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament will take place in St. Mary's, Melmount tomorrow, Monday 19 October after 10.00am Mass until 6.30pm. The Blessed Sacrament can be adored in the Adoration Room, St. Theresa's, Sion Mills anytime while the church is open.

Forty Hours *St. Mary's Church, Melmount Sunday 8 November – Monday 9 November.*

We welcome into God's Family through the Sacrament of Baptism:

Oisin Padraig Robert McHugh

We congratulate the following couple who were recently united in the Sacrament of Marriage:

Aine Timoney and Stephen Harper

May they Rest in Peace

Deaths

Eamon Kelly, 57 Bridge Street

Anniversaries

Patrick Michael O'Sullivan, Barry Langan, Mary Tracey

Andrew Foley, John McPhilemy, Hughie Blee